

Intermediate Elective 2

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Set Up

Packages

```
# general use and cleaning
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(janitor)
library(snakecase)

# wrapping axis labels
library(scales)

# reading in .xlsx files
library(readxl)

# arranging plots
library(patchwork)

# text stuff
library(ggtext)
```

Data

```
# taxonomic information
taxon_list <- read_csv(here("data", "taxon_list.csv"))
```

```

# aquatic invertebrates
aq_ins <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
  sheet = "Aquatic Insects")

# site information
sites <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
  sheet = "sites")

# water quality
water_quality <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling
  ↪ Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
  sheet = "Water Quality",
  na = c("", "n/a", "N/A", "over", "173+"))

```

Cleaning

```

# creating new object from sites
ncos_sites <- sites %>%
  # filter to only include NCOS sites sampled four times a year
  filter(sector == "NCOS" & sampling_frequency == "Quarterly")

```

```

# creating new object from taxon_list
taxon_list_clean <- taxon_list %>%
  # clean taxon names
  mutate(verbatim_name = to_any_case(verbatim_name, case = "snake"))

```

```

# creating new clean object from water quality
water_quality_clean <- water_quality %>%
  # clean column names
  clean_names() %>%
  # filtering join: only include sites in ncos_sites
  semi_join(ncos_sites, by = "site") %>%
  # create new column to join with later data frames
  unite("date_site", date, site, remove = TRUE) %>%
  # group by date_site column
  group_by(date_site) %>%
  # calculate median pH, salinity, DO
  summarize(
    med_ph = median(p_h, na.rm = TRUE),
    med_sal = median(salinity_ppt, na.rm = TRUE),

```

```

        med_do = median(dissolved_oxygen_mg_l, na.rm = TRUE)) %>%
# ungroup data frame
ungroup() %>%
# filter out salinity outliers
filter(date_site != "2022-08-12_NVBR")

# creating new object from aquatic inverts
aq_ins_clean <- aq_ins %>%
# clean column names
clean_names() %>%
# filtering join to only include sites occurring in ncos_sites
semi_join(ncos_sites, by = c("site")) %>%
# renaming columns
rename(date = date_on_vial) %>%
# select columns of interest
select(date, sample_type, site,
        ostracod,
        copepod,
        hemiptera_corixidae_boatman,
        cladocera,
        nematode,
        diptera_ceratopogonidae,
        annelida_oligochaete,
        diptera_chironomid,
        annelida_polychaete) %>%
# filter to only include filter beaker samples
filter(sample_type %in% c("FB 250", "FB250")) %>%
# convert to long format
pivot_longer(cols = ostracod:annelida_polychaete,
              names_to = "taxon",
              values_to = "abundance") %>%
# group by date, site, taxon
group_by(date, site, taxon) %>%
# calculate average abundance per liter
summarize(ave_lit = sum(abundance, na.rm = TRUE)/7.5) %>%
# ungroup after
ungroup() %>%
# create a new column called `date_site` to join with water quality
unite("date_site", date, site, remove = FALSE) %>%
# join with water quality
left_join(water_quality_clean, by = c("date_site")) %>%
# join with taxon list

```

```

left_join(taxon_list_clean, by = c("taxon" = "verbatim_name")) %>%
# full name of sites
mutate(site_full = case_when(
  site == "NVBR" ~ "North of Venoco Bridge",
  site == "NEC" ~ "South of Venoco Bridge",
  site == "NMC" ~ "Main Channel",
  site == "NPB" ~ "South of Phelps Bridge",
  site == "NPB1" ~ "North of Phelps Bridge",
  site == "NPB2" ~ "Phelps Road",
  site == "NWP" ~ "West Pond",
  site == "NDC" ~ "Devereux Creek"
)) %>%
# factor levels for site
mutate(site_full = fct_reorder(site_full, med_sal, .fun = "median", .na_rm
  ↪  = TRUE),
  site_full = fct_rev(site_full))

```

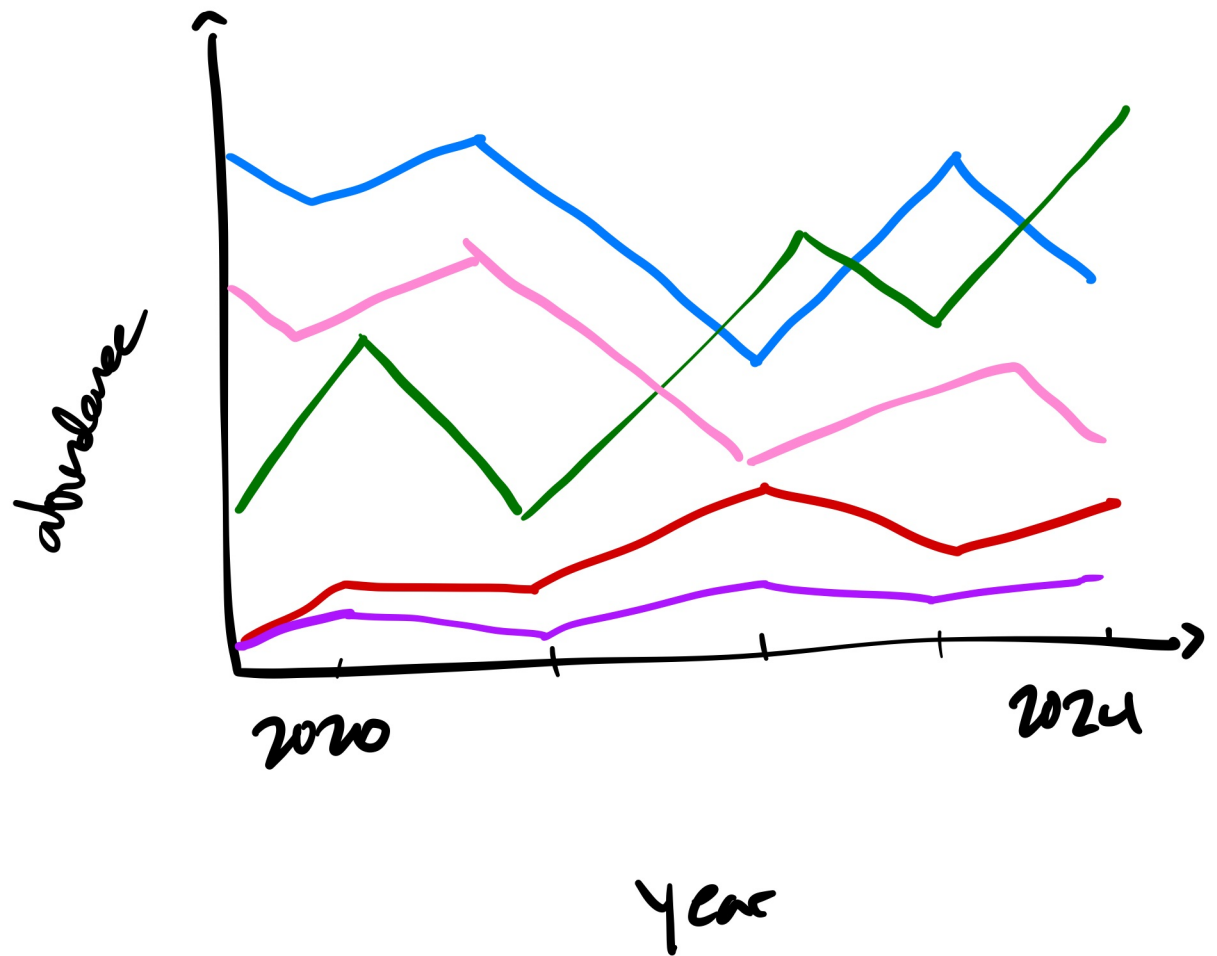
Problems

1. Explain your inspiration

I chose Steven Ponce's visual of China's electricity generation mix. I thought using this as inspiration made sense since I could do something similar and visualizing a mix of species (or something similar) in the NCOS space. I would probably keep **year** as my x-axis since I am showing my y-variable over time. I would have my **taxon** on the y-axis, and each different one would be represented by a different color.

2. Plan your figure

Taxon Abundance in Neos
Aquatic Community



3. Code your figure

Time series

```
taxa_year <- aq_ins_clean %>%
  mutate(year = year(date)) %>%
  group_by(year, taxon) %>%
  summarize(total_ave_lit = sum(ave_lit, na.rm = TRUE), .groups = "drop") %>%
  # including these taxon
  filter(taxon %in% c(
    "ostracod",
    "copepod",
    "hemiptera_corixidae_boatman",
    "cladocera",
    "nematode",
    "diptera_ceratopogonidae",
    "diptera_chironomid",
    "annelida_oligochaete"
  )) |>
  mutate(
    taxon_label = case_when(
      taxon == "ostracod" ~ "Ostracod",
      taxon == "copepod" ~ "Copepod",
      taxon == "hemiptera_corixidae_boatman" ~ "Corixidae",
      taxon == "cladocera" ~ "Cladocera",
      taxon == "nematode" ~ "Nematode",
      taxon == "diptera_ceratopogonidae" ~ "Ceratopogonidae",
      taxon == "diptera_chironomid" ~ "Chironomid",
      taxon == "annelida_oligochaete" ~ "Oligochaete"
    ),
    # log + 1 transform to match the copepod abundance transform used in the
    # rest of the analysis
    log_total = log(total_ave_lit + 1)
  )
```

Color & linetype palettes

```
#} label: visuals

# corresponding colors
```

```

pal <- c(
  "Copepod"      = "#4fc3f7",
  "Ostracod"     = "#81c784",
  "Cladocera"    = "#ffb74d",
  "Corixidae"    = "#ce93d8",
  "Chironomid"   = "#f48fb1",
  "Ceratopogonidae" = "#80cbc4",
  "Nematode"     = "#bcaaa4",
  "Oligochaete"  = "#a5d6a7"
)

#corresponding lines
lty_pal <- c(
  "Copepod"      = "solid",
  "Ostracod"     = "dashed",
  "Cladocera"    = "dotted",
  "Corixidae"    = "longdash",
  "Chironomid"   = "twodash",
  "Ceratopogonidae" = "dashed",
  "Nematode"     = "dotted",
  "Oligochaete"  = "longdash")

```

Labels

```

end_labels <- taxa_year %>%
  group_by(taxon_label) %>%
  slice_max(year, n = 1) %>%
  ungroup()

```

Theme colors

```

navy_bg  <- "#0a1628"
panel_bg <- "#0d1f38"
grid_col <- "#1e3a52"
text_col <- "#e8e4d8"
sub_col  <- "#8aabbf"
axis_col <- "#6a9ab5"

```

Making Visual

```
p <- taxa_year %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = year,
             y = log_total,
             color = taxon_label,
             group = taxon_label)) +
  # Lines + points
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.9, na.rm = TRUE) +
  geom_point(size = 2.5, na.rm = TRUE) +

  # Right-side taxon labels (replaces legend)
  geom_text(
    data = end_labels,
    aes(label = taxon_label),
    hjust = -0.12,
    size = 3,
    na.rm = TRUE
  ) +

  # X-axis: one tick per year, extra right margin for labels
  scale_x_continuous(
    breaks = 2020:2024,
    expand = expansion(mult = c(0.03, 0.22))
  ) +

  # Y-axis: log + 1 scale
  scale_y_continuous(
    name = "log(avg. individuals / L + 1)",
    breaks = 0:7,
    expand = expansion(mult = c(0.05, 0.1))
  ) +

  # Palettes (no legend - labels carry that information)
  scale_color_manual(values = pal, guide = "none") +
  scale_linetype_manual(values = lty_pal, guide = "none") +

  # Titles
  labs(
    title = "Copepods and ostracods dominate NCOS invertebrate
  ↪ communities",
    subtitle = paste0(
```



```

    "Sum of average individuals per liter (FB 250 samples, NCOS quarterly
    ↪ sites) \u00b7 ",
    "log(x\u00a0+\u00a01) transformed \u00b7 2020\u20132024"
  ),
  caption = paste0(
    "SOURCE: Aquatic Sampling Data 2020\u20132025 \u00b7 ",
    "Sites: NDC, NEC, NMC, NPB, NPB1, NPB2, NVBR \u00b7 ",
    "Sample type: filtered beaker 250\u00a0mL"
  ),
  x = NULL
) +

# making theme
theme_minimal(base_size = 11) +
theme(
  plot.background = element_rect(fill = navy_bg, color = NA),
  panel.background = element_rect(fill = panel_bg, color = NA),
  panel.grid.major = element_line(color = grid_col, linewidth = 0.35),
  panel.grid.minor = element_blank(),
  axis.text = element_text(color = axis_col, size = 9),
  axis.title.y = element_text(color = axis_col, size = 9,
                               margin = margin(r = 8)),
  axis.ticks = element_line(color = grid_col),
  plot.title = element_text(color = text_col, size = 15,
                             face = "bold", margin = margin(b = 4)),
  plot.subtitle = element_text(color = sub_col, size = 9.5,
                                margin = margin(b = 14)),
  plot.caption = element_text(color = "#4a6a80", size = 7.5,
                               hjust = 0, margin = margin(t = 10)),
  plot.margin = margin(20, 24, 14, 20)
)

```

Save

```

ggsave(
  filename = "aquatic_taxa_timeseries.png",
  plot = p,
  width = 10,
  height = 6,
  dpi = 300,

```

```
bg = navy_bg)

message("Saved \u2192 aquatic_taxa_timeseries.png")
```

4. Describe your process

I forked his repository in order to use the same code to build this figure. I basically just copied and pasted everything, but I didn't realize that he used custom code to build his figure and it was a little difficult trying to figure out how to get it to run on my end. I thought it was also cool that you could do that. I would say this visual is a lot less boring to look at than figures that were made previously. I think the colors and the cleaner look make the visuals more appealing to look at.